Meaghan I. Clark

NSF Postdoctoral Scholar, Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology, University of California, Santa Cruz

miclark@ucsc.edu https://github.com/MeaghanClark

Appointments

2025–present **NSF Postdoctoral Scholar, Global Change Research Group, University of California, Santa Cruz, CA**
Dynamics of evolutionary rescue in giant kelp.

Education

2024 **W.K. Kellogg Biological Station, Michigan State University (MSU), Hickory Corners, MI**
PhD in in Integrative Biology and Ecology, Evolution, and Behavior
Graduate Advisors: Drs. Gideon Bradburd and Sarah Fitzpatrick

2019 **California State University, Northridge (CSUN), CA**
M.S. in Biology, Graduate Advisor: Dr. Jeanne Robertson

2015 **Whitman College, Walla Walla, WA**
M.A. in Biology

Research and Professional Experience

2019–2024 **Graduate Researcher, Fitzpatrick & Bradburd Labs, MSU, Hickory Corners, MI**
Inferring historical demography and inbreeding in eastern massasauga rattlesnakes, and using simulations to explore the genetic signatures of population decline.

2016–2019 **Graduate Researcher, Robertson Lab, CSUN, Northridge, CA**
Investigating the evolutionary origins of red-eyed treefrog color-pattern variation using field and genomic techniques.

2015–2016 **Research Aide, Waits & Hohenlohe Labs, University of Idaho, Moscow, ID**
Supported conservation and evolutionary genomic projects by extracting and amplifying DNA from low- and high-quality samples and generating genetic and genomic data using microsatellite and BestRAD approaches.

Publications

5. **Clark M.I.**, Hileman E.T., Moore J.A., Faust L.J., Junge R.E., Reid B.N., Bradke D.R., Bradburd G.S., and Fitzpatrick F.W.**2025.** Inbreeding reduces fitness in spatially structured populations of a threatened rattlesnake. Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences 122 (34) e2501745122. doi:10.1073/pnas.2501745122.

4. **Clark M.I.**, Fitzpatrick F.W., and Bradburd G.S. **2024.** Pitfalls and windfalls of detecting demographic declines using population genetics in long-lived species. Evolutionary Applications 17, pp. e13754.

3. **Clark M.I.**, Bradburd G.S., Akopyan M., Vega A., Rosenblum E.B., and Robertson J.M. **2022.** Genetic isolation by distance underlies color pattern divergence in red-eyed treefrogs (*Agalychnis callidryas*). Molecular Ecology 31, pp.1666-1681.

2. Stahlke A.R., Bitume E.V., Ozsoy A.Z., Bean, D.W. Veillet, A., **Clark M.I.**, Clark E.I., Moran P., Hufbauer R.A., and Hohenlohe P.A. **2022.** Hybridization and range expansion in tamarisk beetles (*Diorhabda* spp.) introduced to North

America for classical biological control. Evolutionary Applications, 15, 60-77.

1. Talavera J. B., Collosi E., **Clark M. I.**, Robertson J. M., and Gray D. A. **2021.** Minimal prezygotic isolation between ecologically divergent sibling species. Biological Journal of the Linnean Society, 132(1), 32-43.

Grant Support

Total awarded for research: $74,500

2024 | NSF Postdoctoral Research Fellowship in Biology (PRFB), $240,000

2022,23 | W.K. Kellogg Biological Station Research Award, MSU, $11,000

2017 | Sigma Xi Grant-in-Aid of Research, $1,000
Julie Gorchynski, M.D., Graduate Research Grant, CSUN, $1,000
Gaige Fund Award, American Society of Ichthyologists and Herpetologists, $500

2016 | Thesis Support Award, CSUN, $1000

Awards and Honors

2025 | W.D. Hamilton Award, Honorable Mention, Society for the Study of Evolution

2024 | Dissertation Completion Fellowship, MSU, $10,000

2022 | Outstanding Scholar Fellowship, MSU, $7,500
Don Hall Fellowship, MSU, $6,625

2021 | Summer Fellowship in Ecology, Evolution, and Behavior, MSU, $5625

2019 | Outstanding Thesis/Graduate Project Competition Winner, CSUN, $1500
Hugo and Irma Oppenheimer Award, CSUN, $200
Donald E. Bianchi Outstanding Graduate Research Award, CSUN, $200
Donald E. Bianchi Outstanding Graduate Student Award, CSUN, $200
Julie Gorchynski, M.D. Graduating Master's Student Award, CSUN, $200
Association of Retired Faculty Award, CSUN, $2,000
University Distinguished Fellowship, MSU, $70,000

2018 | James R. Simpson Merit Scholarship, CSUN, $2,000
Associated Students Scholarship in Honor of Jolene Koester, CSUN, $8,000
Graduate Equity Fellowship, CSUN, $2,000
Lori and Dr. Bob Luszczak Graduate Scholarship in Biology, CSUN, $1,000
Outreach Program Award for Girls in Science and Technology, CSUN Matador Involvement Center, CSUN; Awarded to CSUN Women in Science

2017 | Graduate Fellowship for Outstanding Research Promise in Science and Mathematics, CSUN, $5,000

Natural History Publications

1. Vega A., **Clark M.I.**, Chaves G. (2019). *Agalychnis spurrelli*. Geographic range expansion. Herpetological Review. 50(3).

Invited Talks

Feb 2026	Genomic and demographic data reveal the evolutionary trajectories of wild populations in the face of environmental change, Ecology and Evolutionary Biology Department Seminar, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
Dec 2025	Genomic and demographic data reveal the evolutionary trajectories of wild populations in the face of environmental change, Ecology and Evolutionary Biology Department Seminar, UCSC

Selected Oral Presentations

* *indicates presenting author*

Clark M.I.*, Hileman E.T., Moore, J.A., Faust L.J., Junge R.E., Reid B.N., Bradburd G.S., Fitzpatrick S.W. (2025, August). Using genomic and long-term demographic data to infer the impacts of fragmentation and inbreeding in a threatened rattlesnake. Ecological Society of America. Baltimore, MD.

Clark M.I.*, Hileman E.T., Moore, J.A., Faust L.J., Junge R.E., Reid B.N., Bradburd G.S., Fitzpatrick S.W. (2025, May). Long-term demographic and genomic data reveal the consequences of land-use change and inbreeding in populations of a threatened rattlesnake. Virtual Evolution. *Finalist and Honorable Mention in Hamilton Award Symposium*.

Clark M.I.*, Hileman E.T., Moore, J.A., Faust L.J., Junge R.E., Reid B.N., Bradburd G.S., Fitzpatrick S.W. (2025, January). Impacts of inbreeding on fitness of a threatened rattlesnake revealed through long term monitoring. American Society of Naturalists. Asilomar, CA. *Invited Symposium Speaker*.

Clark M.I.*, Hileman E.T., Moore, J.A., Faust L.J., Junge R.E., Reid B.N., Bradburd G.S., Fitzpatrick S.W. (2024, August). Dissecting spatial mechanisms of inbreeding depression in a threatened rattlesnake. Midwest Population Genetics. Bloomington, IN. *First place graduate student talk winner*

Clark M.I.*, Hileman E.T., Moore, J.A., Faust L.J., Junge R.E., Reid B.N., Bradburd G.S., Fitzpatrick S.W. (2024, July). Inbreeding reduces fitness in spatially structured populations of a threatened rattlesnake. Evolution. Montréal, Canada.

Clark M.I.*, Moore, J.A., Hileman E.T., Faust L.J., Bradburd G.S., Fitzpatrick S.W. (2023, June). Leveraging pedigrees in natural populations to learn about demography, inbreeding, and spatial population dynamics in the threatened eastern massasauga rattlesnake. Evolution. Albuquerque, NM.

Clark M.I.*, Fitzpatrick S.W. (2023, May). Secret lives of snakes: Pedigree-based insights into demography and inbreeding in the threatened eastern massasauga rattlesnake. Eastern Massasauga Rattlesnake Species Survival Plan Meeting, Cassopolis, MI. *Invited talk*.

Clark M.I.*, Bradburd G.S. (2022, June). Pitfalls and of detecting demographic declines using population genetics in species with long lifespan and overlapping generations. Evolution. Cleveland, OH.

Clark M.I.*, Fitzpatrick S.W. (2021, May). Quantifying inbreeding and fitness in Michigan massasaugas using pedigree reconstruction. Eastern Massasauga Rattlesnake Species Survival Plan Meeting, Cassopolis, MI. Invited talk.

Clark M.I.*, Akopyan M., Bradburd G.S., Vega A., Robertson J.M. (2018, Jan). Unraveling the rainbow: Evolution of red-eyed treefrogs in a hot-spot of color pattern diversity. Society for Integrative and Comparative Biology. San Francisco, CA.

Selected Poster Presentations

** indicates presenting author*

Clark M.I.*, Moritsch, M.M., Roberts R.L., Elsmore K., Raimondi P.T., Pinsky M.L. (2025, June). Designing genomic monitoring approaches for giant and bull kelp in coastal California amid marine heat waves. Evolution. Athens, GA.

Clark M.I.*, Moore, J.A., Hileman E.T., Faust L.J., Bradburd G.S., Fitzpatrick S.W. (2023, August). Inbreeding and spatial dynamics in eastern massasauga rattlesnakes. Midwest Population Genetics. Ann Arbor, MI. Best graduate poster presentation winner.

Clark M.I.*, Bradburd G.S. (2021, August). Pitfalls and promise of conservation genetics in long-lived species. Midwest Population Genetics. Madison, WI.

Clark M.I.*, Saporito R.A., Vega A., Robertson J.M. (2019, July). Tasting the rainbow: variation in palatability and color pattern in red-eyed treefrogs. Joint Meeting of Ichthyologists and Herpetologists. Snowbird, UT.

Clark M.I.*, Akopyan M., Bradburd G.S., Vega A., Robertson J.M. (2018, July). Orange to Purple: Evolutionary history of red-eyed treefrogs in a hotspot of color pattern diversity. Joint Meeting of Ichthyologists and Herpetologists. Rochester, NY.

Clark M.I.*, Akopyan M., Vega A., Robertson J.M. (2017, June). Detecting hybridization in red-eyed treefrogs (*Agalychnis callidryas*) through genomics and color pattern distribution. Evolution. Portland, OR.

Teaching Experience

** indicates instructor of record*

Fall 2020, 21, 22	Teaching Assistant, Department of Integrative Biology, MSU *Course: Statistical Methods in Ecology and Evolution I*
2016-2019	Teaching Associate*, Department of Biology, CSUN *Course: Introductory biology lab for biology majors (13 sections over 6 semesters)*
2016-2018	Graduate Assistant, Department of Biology, CSUN *Courses: Upper-division molecular ecology, upper-division bioinformatics, lower-division molecular biology research methods*

Outreach

2026–present	Reseda High School Biomedical Advisory Board Member
March 2025	Evolutionary Resilience in Giant Kelp, Guest Speaker, Seymour Marine Discovery Center Docent Training, Santa Cruz, CA
Oct 2020	Genomics in Evolutionary Biology, Guest Speaker, Biological Sciences class, Reseda High School, Los Angeles, CA
Jan 2020	What is Evolutionary Biology?, Guest Speaker, Biomedical Sciences class, Reseda High School, Los Angeles, CA
2017–19	Coordinator for Girls in Science and Technology Club, Portola Middle School *Plan and lead bi-monthly STEM activities for 8th grade girls; Served as head coordinator for the 2017-18 school year.*
2018–19	Science Lab Volunteer Instructor, Dearborn Elementary School *Design and teach hour-long science enrichment lessons for grades K—5 twice a semester.*
Spring 2018	Head Coordinator for Spring Science Exploration Series, Los Angeles Public Library *Organized three workshops to introduce middle school students to STEM fields and careers.*

Leadership and Service

2026–present	Member, DEI Committee, Genomics Institute, UCSC
2023–24	Graduate Student Representative, DEI Committee, EEB Program, MSU
2022–23	Graduate Student Representative, W.K. Kellogg Biological Station, Seminar Committee MSU
2021–23	Graduate Student Representative, Department of Integrative Biology Graduate Student Affairs Committee, MSU
2021–22	Recruitment Liaison, EEB Graduate Group, MSU
2020-21	Colloquium Co-Chair, EEB, Graduate Group, MSU
2017–18	President, Behavior, Ecology, Evolution, and Research Club, CSUN

Professional Training

2026	Equity-minded Mentoring in Higher Education, UCSC, Santa Cruz, CA. *Quarter-long certificate course in critical mentoring*
2020	SLiM Workshop, Ithaca, NY. *One-week training workshop in SLiM simulation framework*

Journal Reviews

Conservation Genetics, Genome Biology and Evolution, Evolutionary Applications, Ecological Applications, Integrative Zoology, Molecular Ecology